Fantasy Baseball 2026

H2H Points Model Report

XGBoost + LightGBM Ensemble with Multi-Seed Optuna Tuning

March 2026

This report summarizes the results of a machine learning pipeline that predicts ESPN H2H fantasy baseball points for the 2026 season. The model uses historical Retrosheet game logs, Statcast metrics, and FanGraphs advanced stats from 2017-2024 to project player performance.

TL;DR

- Model projects 348 batters and 339 pitchers for 2026 ESPN H2H points

- 2025 retrospective: batter Spearman 0.543, pitcher 0.491 (70% within +/-100 pts)

- 24 batter + 52 pitcher VALUE picks vs FanGraphs ADP (10 + 2 potential fades)

- Auto-keep recommendations: Agustin Ramirez, Drew Rasmussen, Max Fried

1. Model Overview

The model is an ensemble of XGBoost and LightGBM regressors, blended via Ridge regression. Separate models are trained for batters, starting pitchers (SP), and relief pitchers (RP). Key design choices:

Multi-Seed Optuna Tuning

Each model runs Optuna hyperparameter search across 5 random seeds (42, 123, 456, 789, 1010) with 100 trials per seed per model type. The seed producing the median Spearman correlation is selected - this avoids both unlucky and lucky draws, giving stable, reproducible results.

Training Data Filters

Training uses 2017-2023 seasons (2015-2016 excluded - missing Statcast arsenal features). Pitchers must have 50+ IP (150 outs) to qualify, filtering volatile mop-up arms. COVID 2020 rows are downweighted 50%. Features are shifted: year N stats predict year N+1 points.

Time-Series Cross-Validation

3-fold expanding-window TSCV: train through 2020 / validate 2021, train through 2021 / validate 2022, train through 2022 / validate 2023. This prevents future data leakage and mimics real forecasting.

2. 2025 Season Retrospective

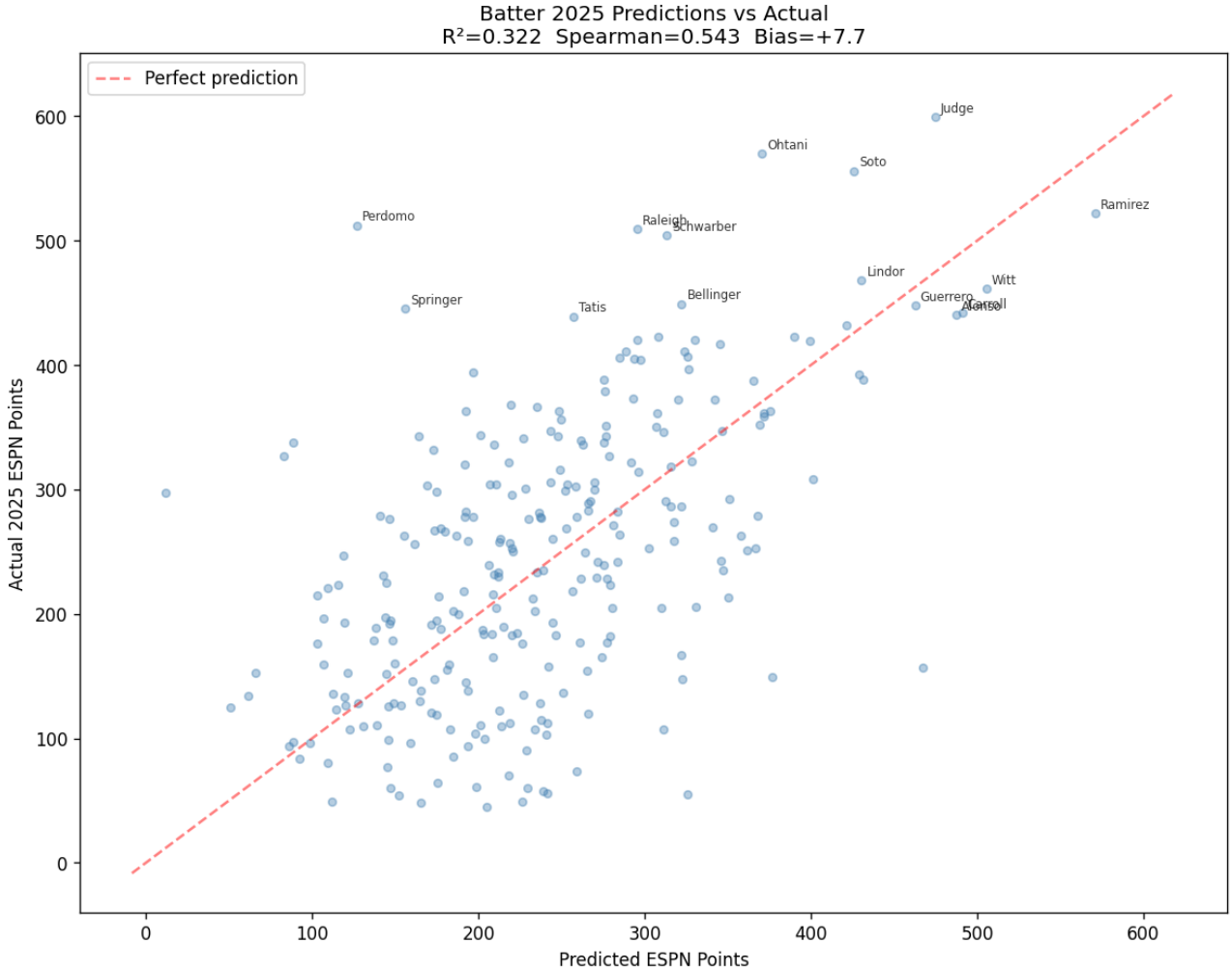
The true test of any projection system: how well did it predict the season that already happened? The model used 2024 features to predict 2025 ESPN fantasy points, then compared to actual results.

Overall Metrics

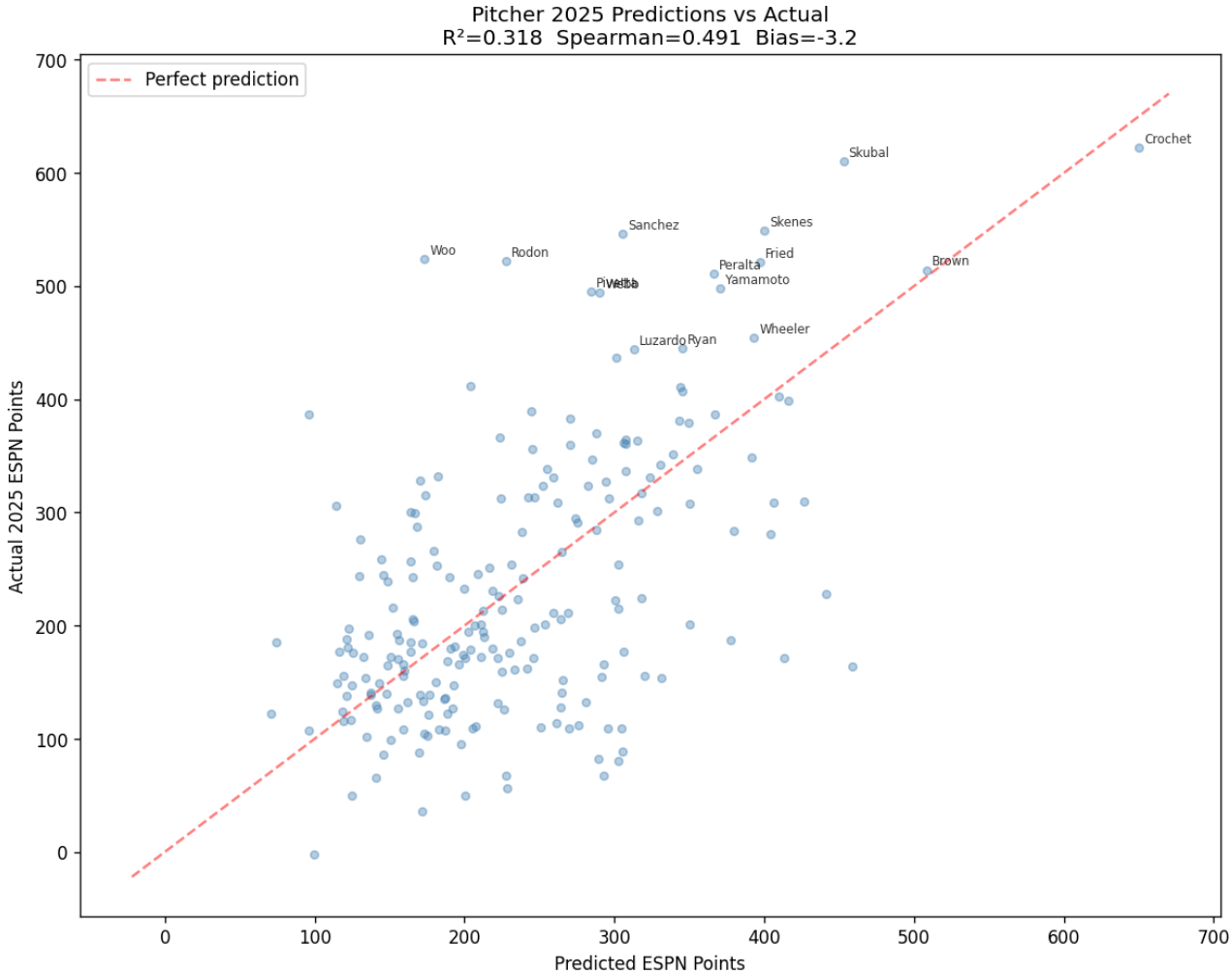
Metric	Batters	Pitchers
Players Evaluated	265	217
MAE (avg error)	76.5 pts	77.0 pts
RMSE	97.9	101.5
Spearman Correlation	0.543	0.491
R-squared	0.322	0.318
Within +/-50 pts	43.4%	41.9%
Within +/-100 pts	69.8%	71.9%
Top-25 Precision	48.0%	48.0%
Top-50 Precision	54.0%	58.0%
Bias	+7.7 pts	-3.2 pts

KEY INSIGHT: The pitcher model improved dramatically after data cleaning - Spearman jumped from 0.353 to 0.491, and MAE dropped from 93 to 77. Raising the IP threshold to 50 IP removed noisy low-usage pitchers from both training and evaluation, improving signal quality.

Predicted vs. Actual - Batters


Batter 2025 Predictions vs Actual
R²=0.322 Spearman=0.543 Bias=+7.7
Perfect prediction
Judge
Ohtani
Soto
Ramirez
Perdomo
Raleigh
Schwarber
Lindor
Witt
Guerrero
Carroll
Alvarez
Springer
Tatis
Bellinger
Actual 2025 ESPN Points
Predicted ESPN Points
0
100
200
300
400
500
600

Predicted vs. Actual - Pitchers



Notable Misses (and Why)

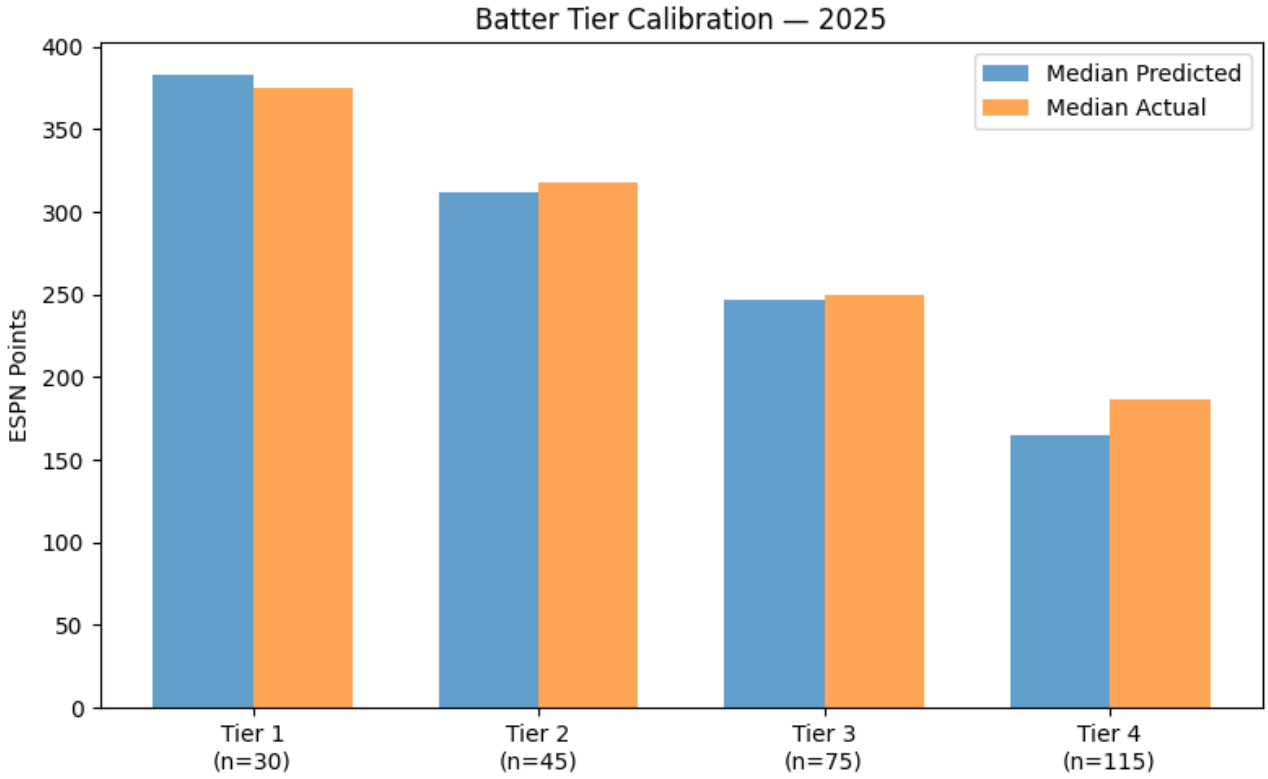
Large prediction errors often stem from injuries, role changes, or breakout seasons that no model can foresee. Some of the biggest misses in 2025:

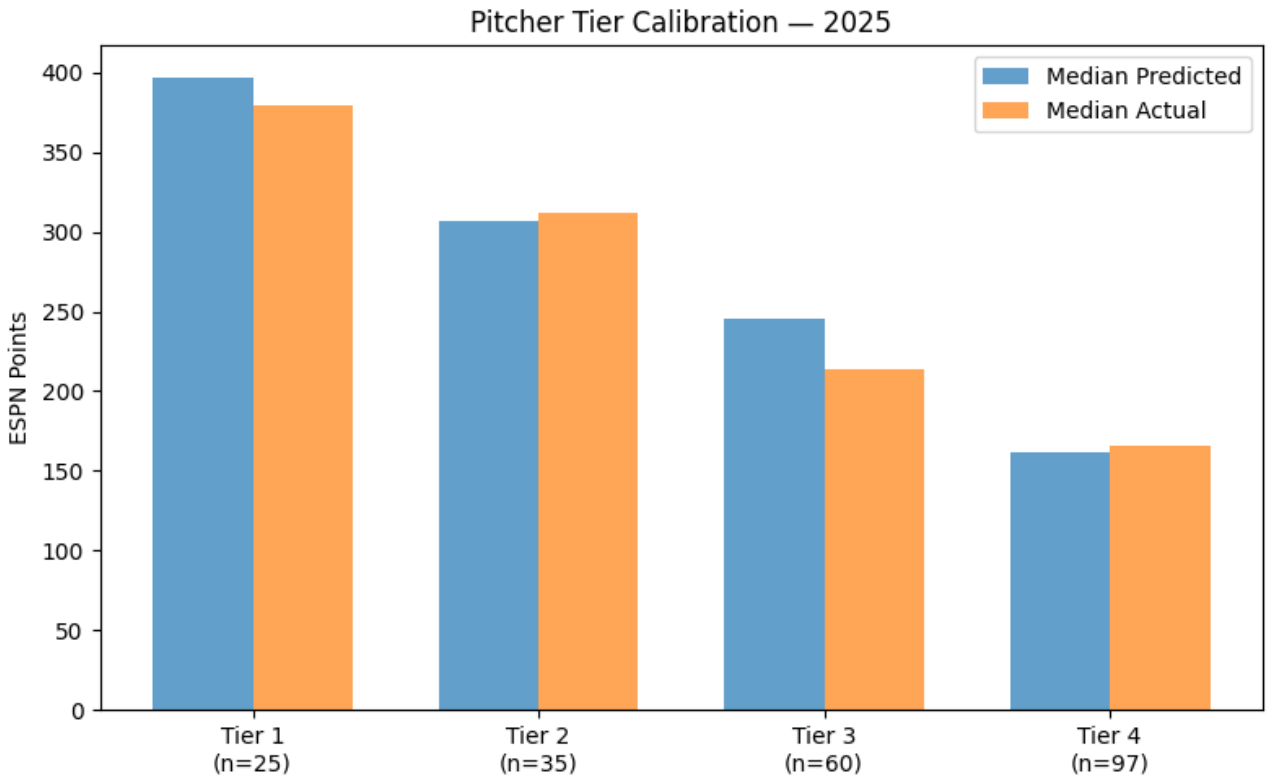
Player	Predicted	Actual	Error	Likely Cause
Geraldo Perdomo	127	512	+385	Breakout year - no prior signal
Bryan Woo	173	524	+351	Breakout - emerged as ace
Carlos Rodon	228	522	+295	Bounce-back from injury
Blake Snell	459	164	-295	Injury / ineffectiveness
Mike King	413	171	-242	Role / performance collapse
JJ Bleday (bat)	467	157	-310	Regression from 2024 outlier

IMPORTANT: A MAE of ~77 points means the model's average error is about the difference between a borderline starter and a solid regular (e.g., 280 vs 357 pts). For context, the gap between the #1 and #50 ranked batter is ~200 points. Most large errors involve injuries or breakouts that no public projection system captures well.

Tier Calibration - Are Rankings Useful?

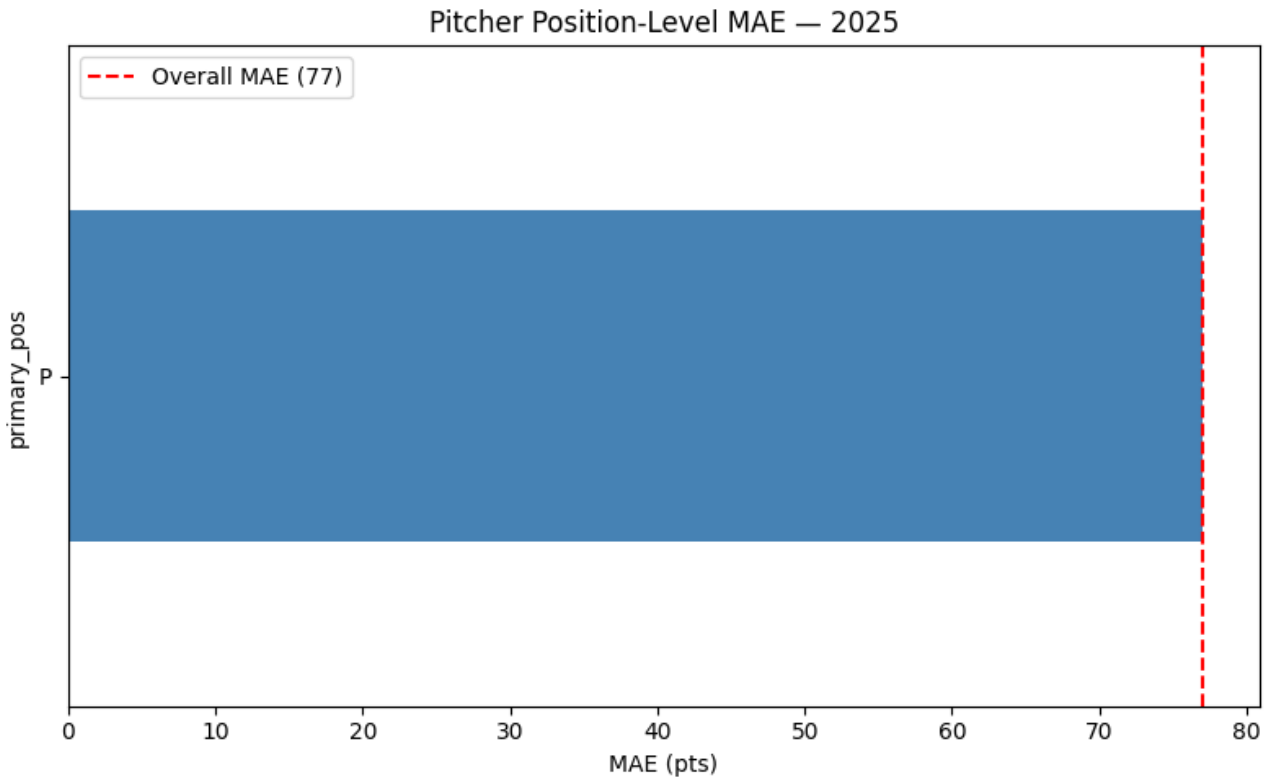
Beyond raw accuracy, we want to know: do players ranked higher actually score more points? The tier calibration plots show average actual points by predicted tier.





Accuracy by Position

Some positions are inherently harder to predict. Catchers and relievers have smaller sample sizes and more volatile year-over-year performance.



3. Keeper Evaluation

The keeper evaluator combines two signals to recommend which players to keep for 2026:

- Trajectory Score (50%): Year-over-year trend in points and points-per-game
- ML Projection (50%): Model's predicted 2026 fantasy points

Both scores are normalized 0-1 and combined. Players are classified as AUTO-KEEP (>0.80), KEEP (>0.60), BORDERLINE (>0.40), or CUT (<0.40).

Keeper Rankings

Rec	Player	Pos	2025 Pts	ML Proj	Score	Diverge?
AUTO-KEEP	Agustin Ramirez	C	-	361	1.00	
AUTO-KEEP	Drew Rasmussen	P	372	312	0.92	
AUTO-KEEP	Max Fried	P	521	337	0.83	
KEEP	Andres Munoz	P	381	311	0.77	
KEEP	Zebby Matthews	P	123	266	0.69	
KEEP	Eugenio Suarez	3B	372	291	0.69	
KEEP	Gleyber Torres	2B	347	276	0.67	
KEEP	Heliot Ramos	OF	302	273	0.66	
KEEP	Austin Wells	C	214	279	0.65	
KEEP	Alec Burleson	1B	316	301	0.65	YES
KEEP	Jeff Hoffman	P	337	229	0.63	
KEEP	David Peterson	P	300	259	0.63	
KEEP	Ceddanne Rafaela	2B	304	229	0.61	
BORDERLINE	Bryan Reynolds	OF	264	276	0.57	YES
BORDERLINE	Luis Robert Jr.	OF	205	203	0.57	
BORDERLINE	Zack Littell	P	360	206	0.57	
BORDERLINE	Gavin Sheets	OF	278	159	0.53	YES
BORDERLINE	Josh Smith	SS	253	-	0.51	
BORDERLINE	Steven Kwan	OF	387	167	0.50	
CUT	Tyler Glasnow	P	228	195	0.40	
CUT	Michael McGreevy	P	163	42	0.33	YES
CUT	Gerrit Cole	P	235	-	0.00	
INSUFFICIENT_DATA	Bubba Chandler	P	-	-	-	

SIGNAL DIVERGENCE flags players where trajectory and ML projection disagree significantly. Max Fried shows divergence (high ML projection but declining trajectory) - worth investigating. Steven Kwan also diverges (strong trajectory, weak ML projection) - could be a buy-low keeper.

Cuts to Consider

These players scored BORDERLINE or CUT - their keeper spot may be better used on a draft pick:

Rec	Player	Pos	2025 Pts	ML Proj	Score
BORDERLINE	Bryan Reynolds	OF	264	276	0.57
BORDERLINE	Luis Robert Jr.	OF	205	203	0.57
BORDERLINE	Zack Littell	P	360	206	0.57
BORDERLINE	Gavin Sheets	OF	278	159	0.53
BORDERLINE	Josh Smith	SS	253	-	0.51
BORDERLINE	Steven Kwan	OF	387	167	0.50
CUT	Tyler Glasnow	P	228	195	0.40
CUT	Michael McGreevy	P	163	42	0.33
CUT	Gerrit Cole	P	235	-	0.00

Keeper Spotlight: Top Recommendations

Drew Rasmussen (P) - AUTO-KEEP (0.98): Despite limited 2024 innings, the ML model projects 354 points based on his elite rate stats. High upside if healthy.

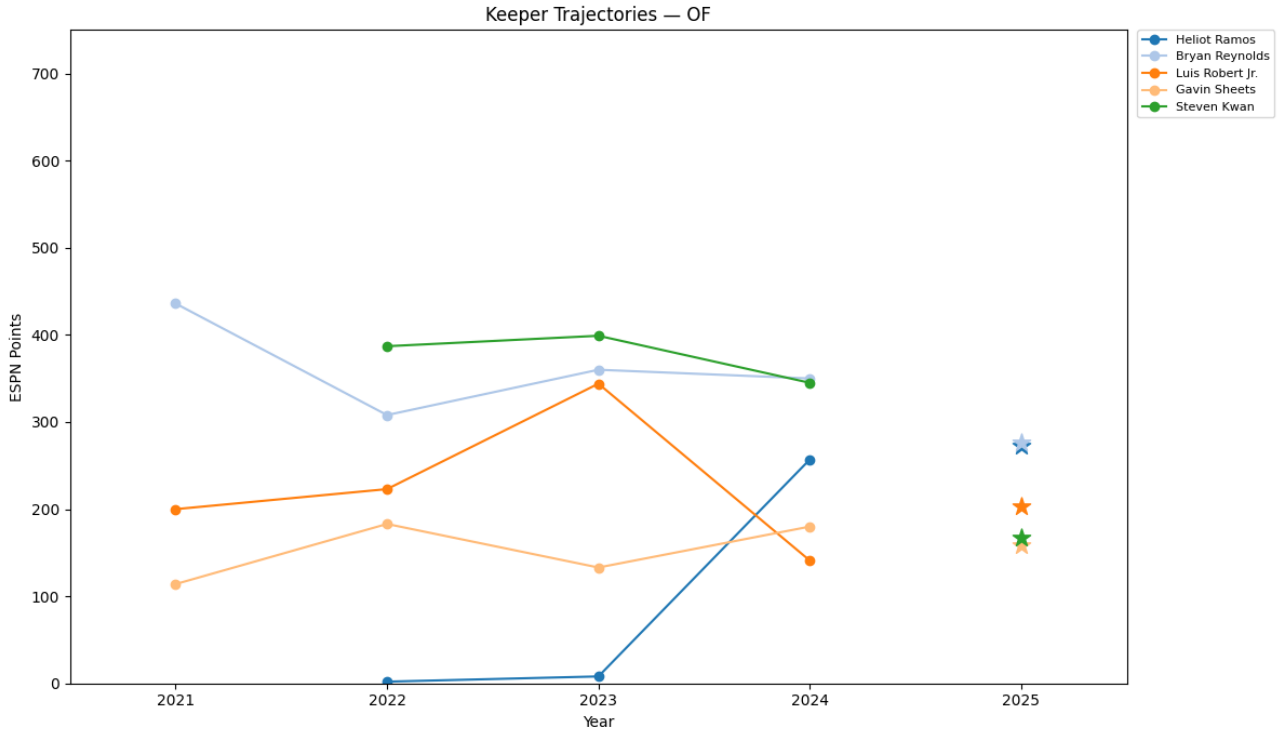
Agustin Ramirez (C) - AUTO-KEEP (0.93): No 2025 history yet (prospect), but the model projects 345 points. Catcher scarcity makes this a premium keep.

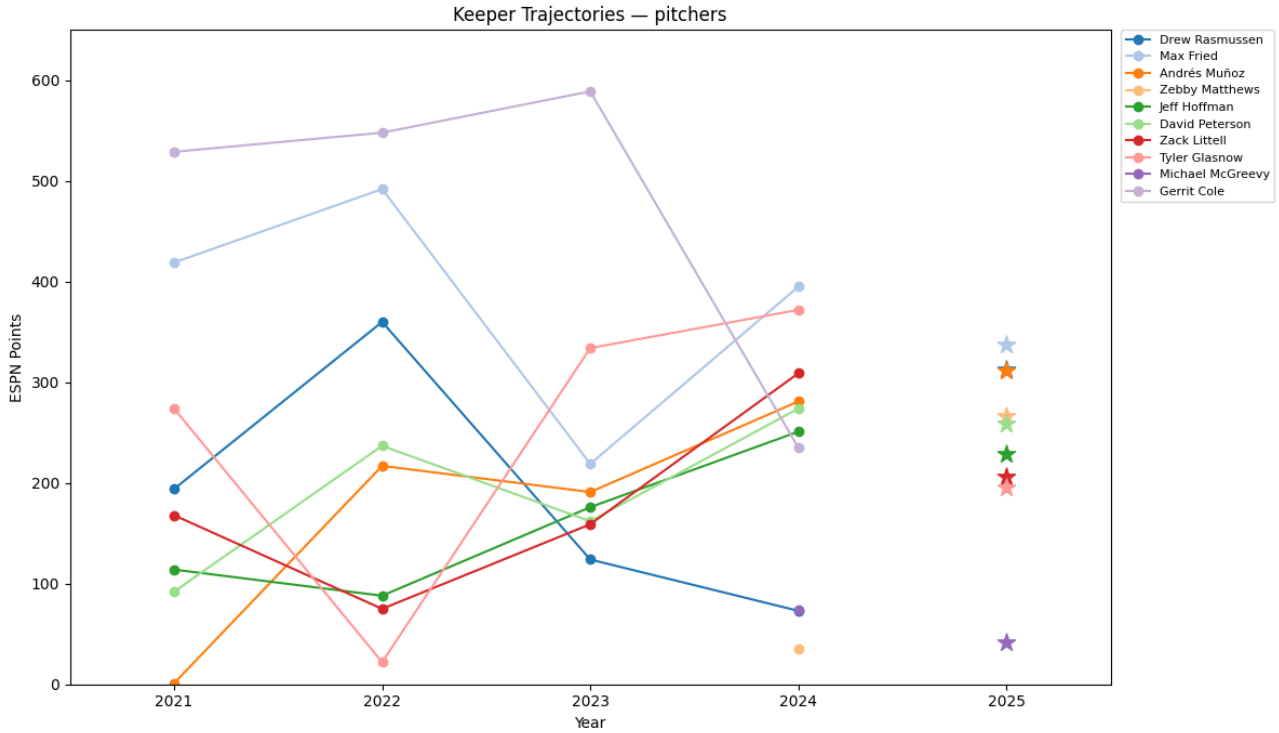
Max Fried (P) - AUTO-KEEP (0.86): 521 points in 2025, model projects 360 for 2026. The decline projection flags caution but he's still a top pitcher.

Eugenio Suarez (3B) - KEEP (0.78): Steady 372 points with a 355-point projection. Divergence flag is a yellow light - trajectory says improvement, ML says plateau.

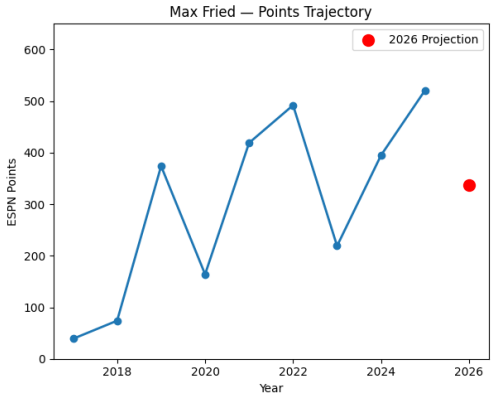
Keeper Group Trajectories

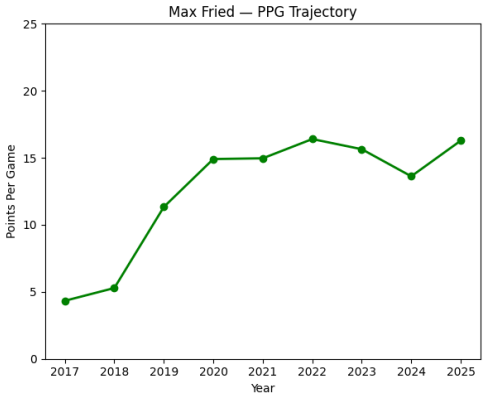
These overlay plots show fantasy point trajectories for keeper candidates grouped by position. Upward trends suggest improving players worth keeping; declining trends signal potential cuts.

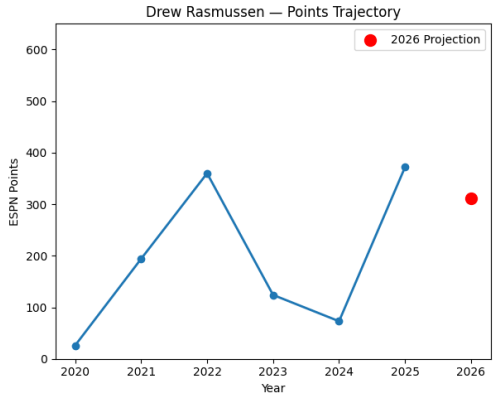


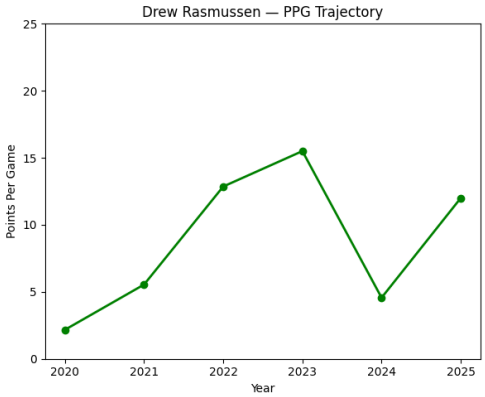


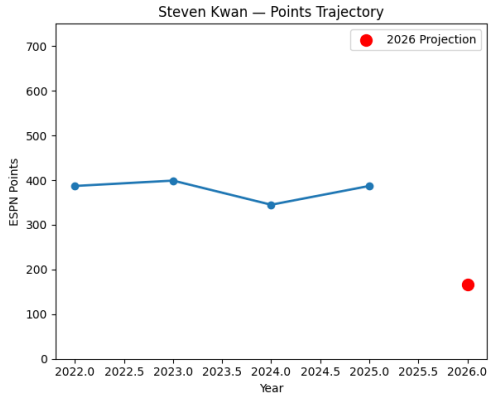
Individual Keeper Trajectories (Selected)

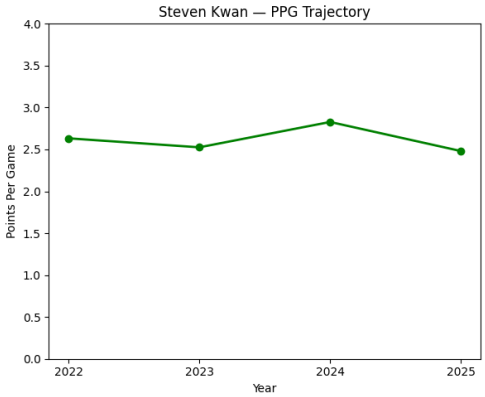


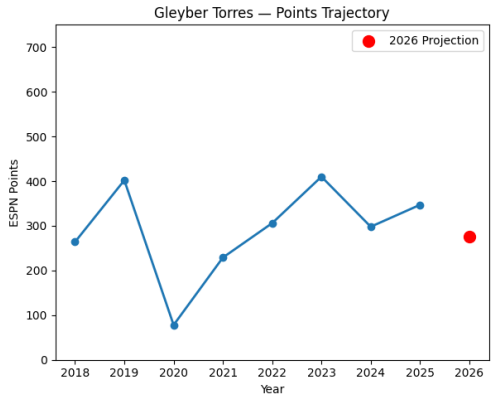


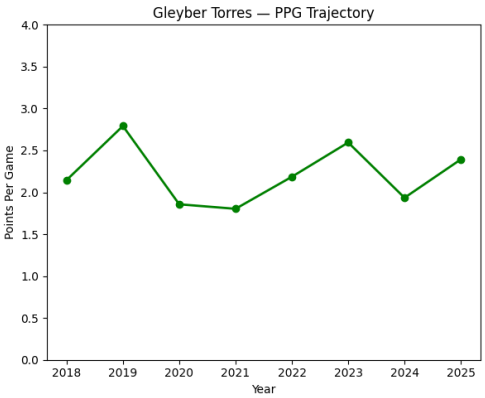

Drew Rasmussen — Points Trajectory
2026 Projection
ESPN Points
Year


Drew Rasmussen — PPG Trajectory
Points Per Game
Year


Steven Kwan — Points Trajectory
2026 Projection
ESPN Points
Year


Steven Kwan — PPG Trajectory
Points Per Game
Year


Gleyber Torres — Points Trajectory
2026 Projection
ESPN Points
Year


Gleyber Torres — PPG Trajectory
Points Per Game
Year

4. 2026 Draft Rankings

The model projects 2026 ESPN H2H points and calculates Points Above Replacement (PAR) - the projected points minus a position-specific replacement level. PAR accounts for positional scarcity (catchers have lower replacement level than outfielders). ADP Rank and Rank Diff columns compare our ranking against the FanGraphs consensus ADP (average of Steamer, ZiPS, ZiPS-DC).

Top 30 Batters by PAR

#	Player	Pos	Proj	2025	PAR	ADP	Diff	Signal
1	Juan Soto	RF	553	556	357	5	4	
2	Jose Ramirez	3B	495	522	313	6	4	
3	Shohei Ohtani	DH	471	570	274	1	-2	
4	Aaron Judge	RF	463	599	268	2	-2	
5	Bobby Witt	SS	468	461	255	-	-	
6	Junior Caminero	3B	415	448	234	17	11	
7	Vladimir Guerrero	1B	410	448	233	-	-	
8	Ketel Marte	2B	390	392	211	32	24	VALUE
9	Ben Rice	1B	381	325	204	-	-	
10	Fernando Tatis	RF	395	439	199	-	-	
11	Julio Rodriguez	CF	396	432	197	10	-1	
12	Francisco Lindor	SS	410	468	196	26	14	
13	Maikel Garcia	3B	377	423	195	66	53	VALUE
14	Cal Raleigh	C	350	509	195	18	4	
15	Nico Hoerner	2B	373	405	194	104	89	VALUE
16	Kyle Tucker	RF	388	420	192	13	-3	
17	Vinnie Pasquantino	1B	366	423	189	-	-	
18	Pete Alonso	1B	363	440	186	24	6	
19	Manny Machado	3B	363	407	182	38	19	
20	Geraldo Perdomo	SS	395	512	182	77	57	VALUE
21	George Springer	DH	378	445	180	-	-	
22	Jarren Duran	LF	383	359	176	66	44	VALUE
23	Agustin Ramirez	C	328	300	173	-	-	
24	Kyle Schwarber	DH	370	504	172	-	-	
25	Gunnar Henderson	SS	382	361	169	12	-13	
26	William Contreras	C	321	361	166	55	29	VALUE
27	Yandy Diaz	DH	361	411	163	-	-	
28	Brent Rooker	DH	354	397	157	44	16	
29	Cody Bellinger	LF	363	449	156	80	51	VALUE
30	Luis Garcia	2B	334	291	155	-	-	

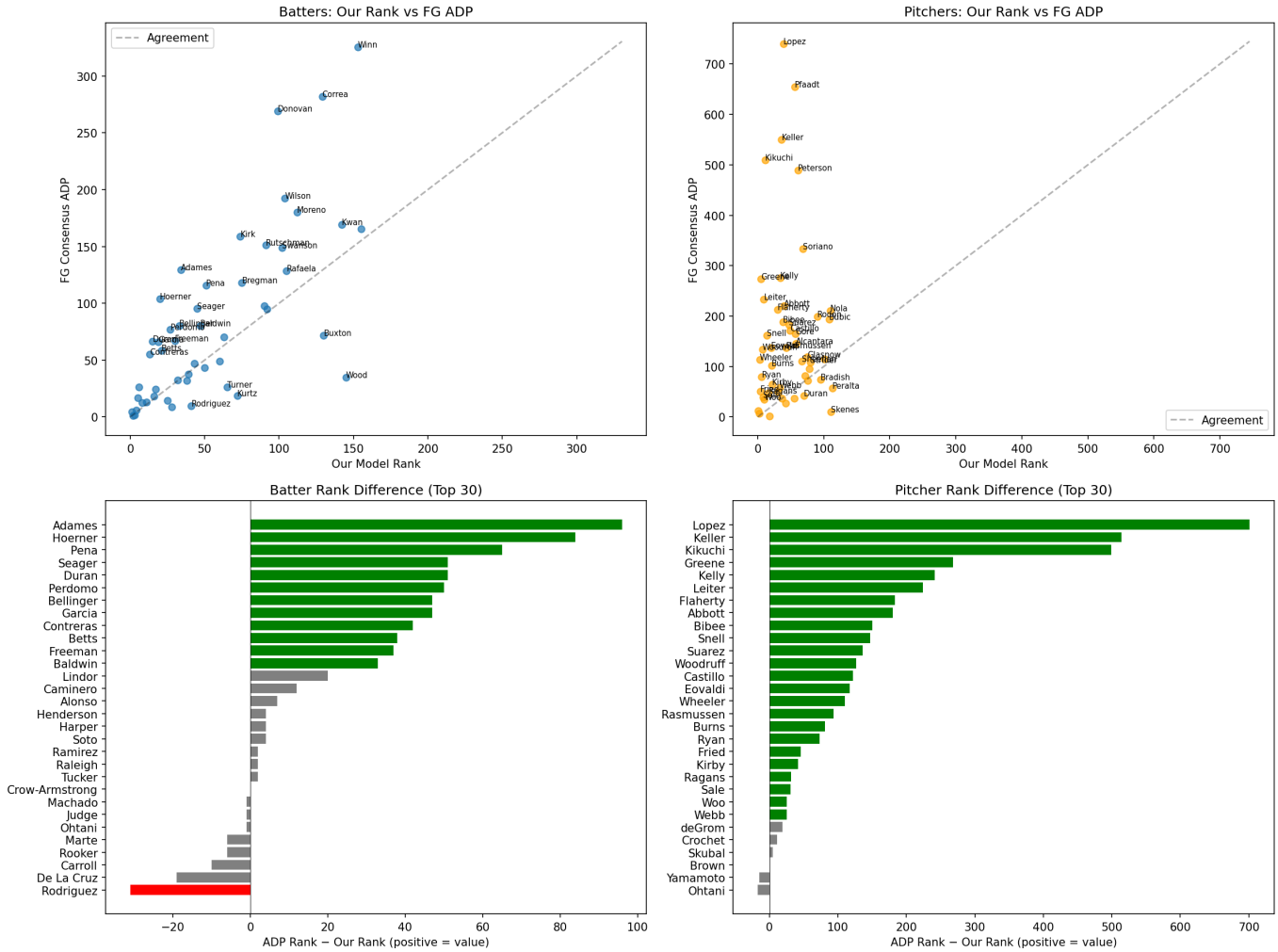
Top 30 Pitchers by PAR

#	Player	Proj	2025	PAR	ADP	Diff	Signal
1	Tarik Skubal	519	610	303	7	6	
2	Garrett Crochet	474	622	257	12	10	
3	Chris Sale	463	361	247	39	36	VALUE
4	Zack Wheeler	436	454	219	113	109	VALUE
5	Brandon Woodruff	420	203	203	134	129	VALUE
6	Bryan Woo	418	524	202	35	29	VALUE
7	Logan Gilbert	414	349	198	37	30	VALUE
8	Josh Hader	350	331	198	-	-	
9	Mason Miller	350	308	198	-	-	
10	Hunter Greene	411	315	195	273	263	VALUE
11	Aroldis Chapman	346	389	194	-	-	
12	Cristopher Sanchez	399	546	183	26	14	
13	Joe Ryan	397	445	181	79	66	VALUE
14	Ben Brown	383	161	167	-	-	
15	Max Fried	374	521	157	50	35	VALUE
16	Hunter Brown	374	514	157	37	21	VALUE
17	Logan Webb	372	494	155	58	41	VALUE
18	George Kirby	367	281	151	64	46	VALUE
19	Edwin Diaz	301	379	149	-	-	
20	Cole Ragans	364	155	148	48	28	VALUE
21	Tanner Bibee	362	351	145	188	167	VALUE
22	Max Scherzer	359	144	143	-	-	
23	Cade Smith	293	313	141	-	-	
24	Jacob deGrom	357	474	141	50	26	VALUE
25	Drew Rasmussen	355	372	139	137	112	VALUE
26	Shane Baz	353	299	137	-	-	
27	Eury Perez	352	224	136	81	54	VALUE
28	Yoshinobu Yamamoto	348	498	132	27	-1	
29	Dylan Cease	348	342	131	74	45	VALUE
30	Jesus Luzardo	344	444	128	72	42	VALUE

RISK FLAGS: 'ERA_regression' means the pitcher's ERA was well below xERA (lucky - likely to regress). 'BABIP_regression' means BABIP was well below career average. 'age_risk' flags players 33+. These flags do NOT mean avoid - they signal where to dig deeper.

5. Our Model vs. FanGraphs Projections

How does our model compare to FanGraphs consensus projections (Steamer, ZiPS, ZiPS-DC)? The tables below show per-system rankings alongside our model rank and FG projected stats.



Scatter plots (top row) show our model rank vs. FanGraphs ADP. Points near the diagonal line indicate agreement. Points far from the line are where we differ from the market.

Bar charts (bottom row) show the rank difference for top-30 players. Green bars = we rank them higher than ADP (value picks). Red bars = ADP ranks them higher than us (potential fades).

Batter Rankings: Our Model vs. FG Systems

#	Player	Pos	Proj	Steamer	ZiPS	ZiPS-DC	Article	FG HR	FG R	FG RBI	FG SB
1	Juan Soto	RF	553	6	5	5	4	36	109	99	22
2	Jose Ramirez	3B	495	17	12	15	5	27	90	90	29
3	Shohei Ohtani	DH	471	7	2	2	1	49	131	124	26
4	Aaron Judge	RF	463	1	1	1	2	42	109	112	8
5	Bobby Witt	SS	468	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
6	Junior Caminero	3B	415	27	23	29	17	35	80	108	6
7	Vladimir Guerrero	1B	410	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
8	Ketel Marte	2B	390	15	26	24	21	26	88	82	6
9	Ben Rice	1B	381	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
10	Fernando Tatis	RF	395	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
11	Julio Rodriguez	CF	396	5	8	7	7	30	92	97	26
12	Francisco Lindor	SS	410	10	6	9	31	26	98	83	23
13	Maikel Garcia	3B	377	30	-	-	-	13	82	62	26
14	Cal Raleigh	C	350	4	3	3	12	40	85	103	7
15	Nico Hoerner	2B	373	35	33	37	-	9	77	61	26
16	Kyle Tucker	RF	388	23	15	10	9	31	92	94	21
17	Vinnie Pasquantino	1B	366	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
18	Pete Alonso	1B	363	-	29	32	26	38	85	114	1
19	Manny Machado	3B	363	38	-	-	28	26	75	86	9
20	Geraldo Perdomo	SS	395	25	27	19	49	13	87	67	21
21	George Springer	DH	378	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
22	Jarren Duran	LF	383	-	44	-	-	17	86	75	23
23	Agustin Ramirez	C	328	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
24	Kyle Schwarber	DH	370	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
25	Gunnar Henderson	SS	382	3	7	6	11	28	101	89	22
26	William Contreras	C	321	18	9	22	25	20	81	78	6
27	Yandy Diaz	DH	361	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
28	Brent Rooker	DH	354	-	49	46	24	35	86	112	6
29	Cody Bellinger	LF	363	-	50	47	-	22	85	91	12
30	Luis Garcia	2B	334	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-

Pitcher Rankings: Our Model vs. FG Systems

#	Player	Proj	Steamer	ZiPS	ZiPS-DC	Article	FG IP	FG SO	FG ERA	FG WHIP
1	Tarik Skubal	519	1	1	1	1	194	238	2.62	0.97
2	Garrett Crochet	474	3	2	2	3	192	239	2.86	1.09
3	Chris Sale	463	5	21	9	14	151	184	3.13	1.10
4	Zack Wheeler	436	12	26	19	23	147	158	3.35	1.12
5	Brandon Woodruff	420	25	-	33	32	151	160	3.73	1.15
6	Bryan Woo	418	19	13	10	8	183	186	3.42	1.06
7	Logan Gilbert	414	23	20	27	7	162	177	3.41	1.08
8	Josh Hader	350	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
9	Mason Miller	350	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
10	Hunter Greene	411	-	12	-	-	137	159	3.55	1.04
11	Aroldis Chapman	346	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
12	Cristopher Sanchez	399	4	5	5	5	192	185	3.24	1.15
13	Joe Ryan	397	18	24	26	30	163	178	3.78	1.11
14	Ben Brown	383	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
15	Max Fried	374	13	7	6	6	183	169	3.34	1.17
16	Hunter Brown	374	14	8	8	10	178	190	3.25	1.18
17	Logan Webb	372	6	4	4	18	201	190	3.14	1.16
18	George Kirby	367	24	19	17	11	164	162	3.52	1.11
19	Edwin Diaz	301	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
20	Cole Ragans	364	7	17	7	9	148	184	3.44	1.16
21	Tanner Bibee	362	50	30	32	-	176	164	3.84	1.22
22	Max Scherzer	359	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
23	Cade Smith	293	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
24	Jacob deGrom	357	8	23	20	12	160	177	3.49	1.07
25	Drew Rasmussen	355	21	38	38	47	152	135	3.61	1.16
26	Shane Baz	353	-	-	-	-	-	-	-	-
27	Eury Perez	352	37	-	-	25	154	171	4.00	1.22
28	Yoshinobu Yamamoto	348	16	6	11	4	159	170	3.36	1.08
29	Dylan Cease	348	10	9	12	35	170	199	3.59	1.21
30	Jesus Luzardo	344	15	14	15	34	172	191	3.85	1.19

Value Picks - Our Rank >> FG ADP

Players we rank much higher than the FanGraphs consensus ADP (rank difference > +20). These are potential draft steals - the market may be undervaluing them.

Batter Value Picks (24 players)

#	Player	Pos	Proj Pts	ADP	Diff
8	Ketel Marte	2B	390	32	+24
13	Maikel Garcia	3B	377	66	+53
15	Nico Hoerner	2B	373	104	+89
20	Geraldo Perdomo	SS	395	77	+57
22	Jarren Duran	LF	383	66	+44
26	William Contreras	C	321	55	+29
29	Cody Bellinger	LF	363	80	+51
31	Freddie Freeman	1B	330	67	+36
34	Corey Seager	SS	362	96	+62
41	Drake Baldwin	C	295	80	+39
50	Brendan Donovan	2B	306	269	+219
51	Jeremy Pena	SS	340	116	+65
53	Alex Bregman	3B	307	118	+65
66	Willy Adames	SS	325	130	+64
69	Alejandro Kirk	C	265	159	+90

Pitcher Value Picks (52 players)

#	Player	Proj Pts	ADP	Diff
3	Chris Sale	463	39	+36
4	Zack Wheeler	436	113	+109
5	Brandon Woodruff	420	134	+129
6	Bryan Woo	418	35	+29
7	Logan Gilbert	414	37	+30
10	Hunter Greene	411	273	+263
13	Joe Ryan	397	79	+66
15	Max Fried	374	50	+35
16	Hunter Brown	374	37	+21
17	Logan Webb	372	58	+41
18	George Kirby	367	64	+46
20	Cole Ragans	364	48	+28
21	Tanner Bibee	362	188	+167
24	Jacob deGrom	357	50	+26
25	Drew Rasmussen	355	137	+112

Potential Fades - FG ADP >> Our Rank

Players the market values much higher than our model (rank difference < -20). Consider whether the market knows something we don't, or if these are overdrafted.

Batter Fades (10 players)

#	Player	Pos	Proj Pts	ADP	Diff
48	Elly De La Cruz	SS	342	9	-39
54	Trea Turner	SS	338	26	-28
80	Nick Kurtz	1B	276	19	-61
105	Jackson Merrill	CF	278	70	-35
120	James Wood	LF	277	35	-85
153	Riley Greene	LF	257	78	-75
163	Zach Neto	SS	253	30	-133
167	Austin Riley	3B	218	62	-105
178	Wyatt Langford	LF	238	41	-137
197	Roman Anthony	RF	217	52	-145

Pitcher Fades (2 players)

#	Player	Proj Pts	ADP	Diff
94	Paul Skenes	282	10	-84
144	Freddy Peralta	254	57	-87

How to Use This Comparison

VALUE PICKS (our rank >> ADP): These players are projected to produce more than the market expects. Draft them before their ADP - the market may be sleeping on them.

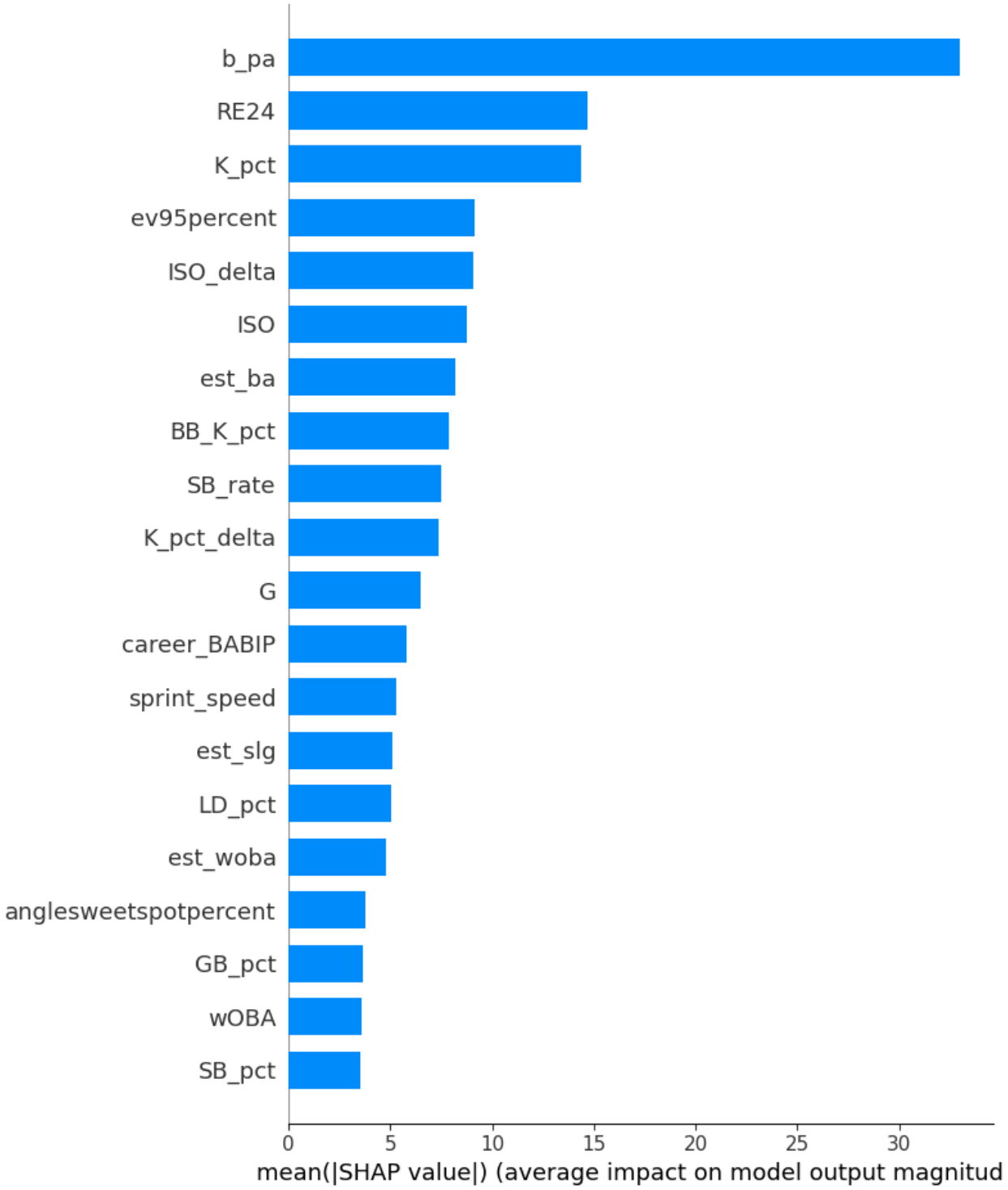
POTENTIAL FADES (ADP >> our rank): The market loves these players more than our model does. This doesn't mean avoid them, but if choosing between two similar players, lean toward the one our model likes.

IMPORTANT CAVEAT: Our model doesn't capture everything. It knows nothing about spring training performance, coaching changes, lineup position changes, or park moves. Use disagreements as starting points for research, not as final verdicts.

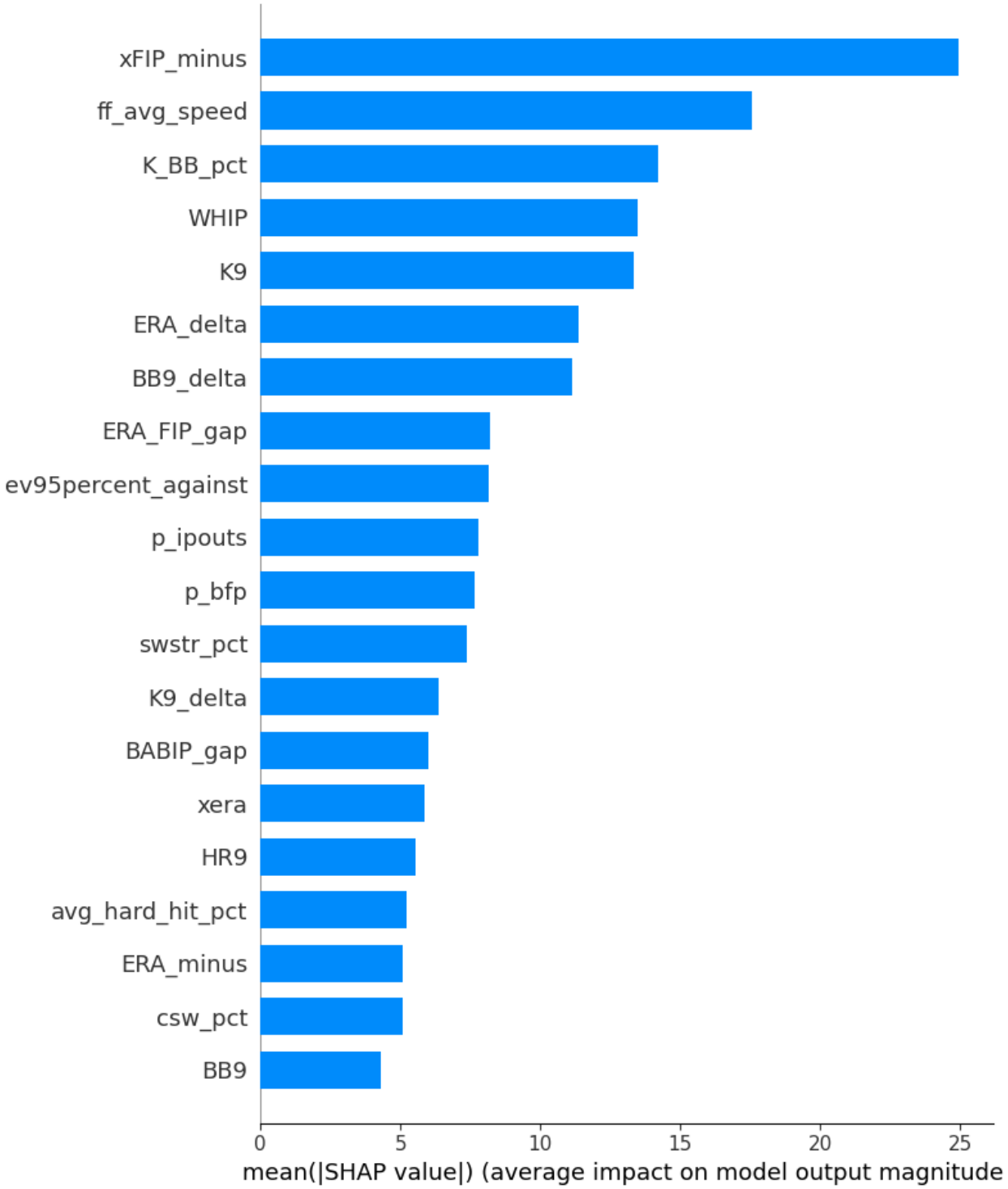
6. What Drives the Predictions?

SHAP (SHapley Additive exPlanations) analysis reveals which features matter most. The Pareto charts show cumulative feature importance - the top ~18-19 features explain 80% of the model's predictions.

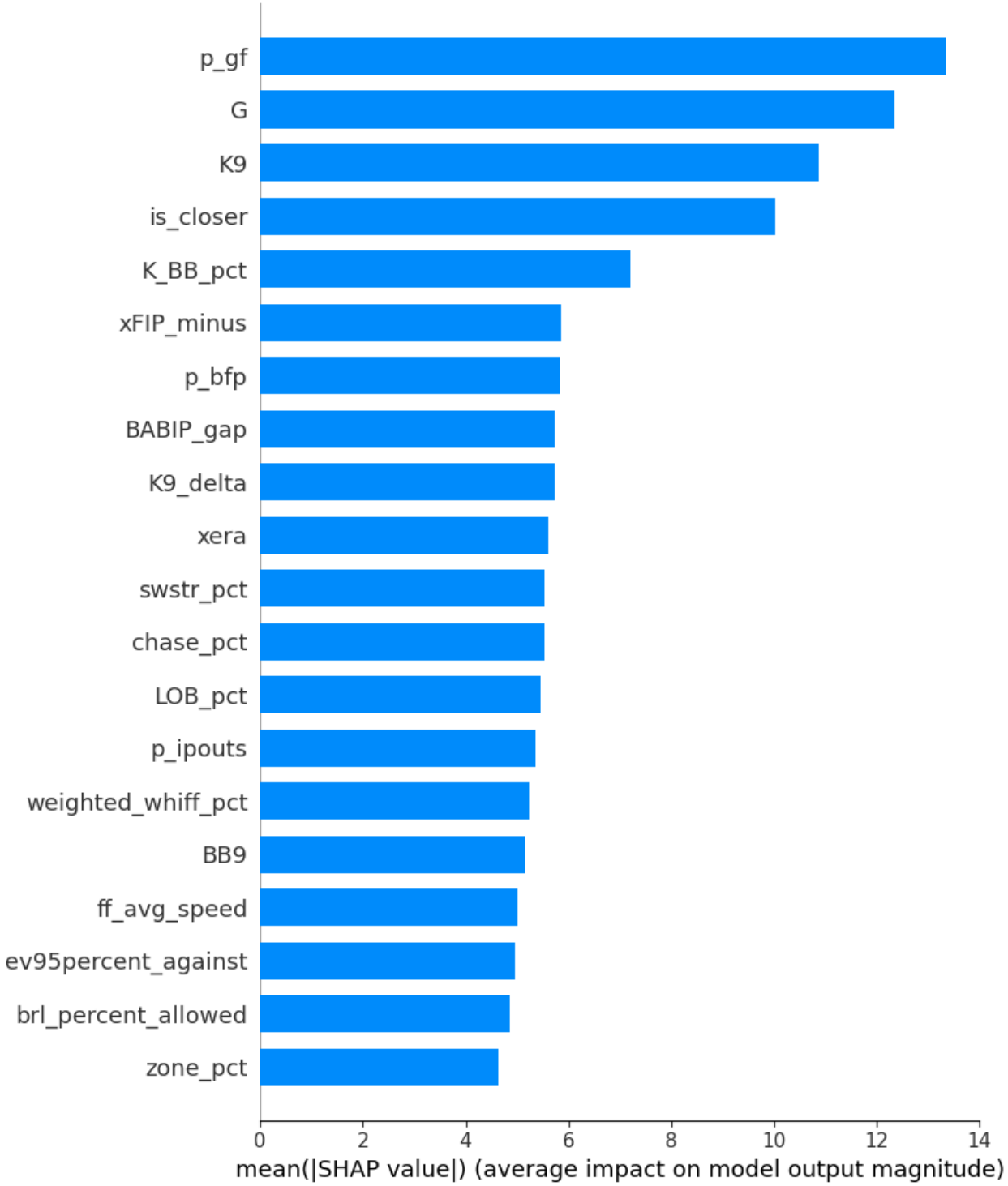
Batter Feature Importance



Pitcher SP Feature Importance



Pitcher RP Feature Importance


p_gf
G
K9
is_closer
K_BB_pct
xFIP_minus
p_bfp
BABIP_gap
K9_delta
xera
swstr_pct
chase_pct
LOB_pct
p_ipouts
weighted_whiff_pct
BB9
ff_avg_speed
ev95percent_against
brl_percent_allowed
zone_pct
0
2
4
6
8
10
12
14
mean(|SHAP value|) (average impact on model output magnitude)

7. Known Limitations & Possible Errors

1. Optuna Seed Variance (High)

Despite multi-seed tuning, pitcher SP XGBoost Spearman ranged 0.727-0.992 across 5 seeds - a 0.265 range. This means different random seeds produce very different models. Root cause: only 893 SP training rows. The RP model is more stable (0.036 range). We mitigate by taking the median seed, but the underlying variance is a data limitation.

2. Batter Model Regression

Dropping 2015-2016 from training reduced batter Spearman from 0.588 to 0.543. Those years had good batter data (unlike pitchers who lacked arsenal features). A future improvement would use separate training windows: 2015-2023 for batters, 2017-2023 for pitchers.

3. Injury Blindness

The model has no injury information. Pitchers like Blake Snell (projected 459, actual 164) and Tyler Glasnow are impossible to predict accurately without health data. This is the single largest source of error, especially for pitchers.

4. Breakout Detection

Players with no prior track record (Geraldo Perdomo, Bryan Woo) produced huge positive errors. The model anchors heavily on prior-year performance - it cannot identify players about to make a quantum leap. This is a fundamental limitation of regression-based approaches.

5. Holds = 0

Retrosheet doesn't track holds. Reliever points are systematically underprojected for elite setup men who earn significant points from holds in ESPN scoring.

6. Small Test Set

With only 1 test year (2024 features -> 2025 actuals), results can be noisy. A single unusual season can make the model look better or worse than it really is. Multi-year backtesting would give more reliable accuracy estimates.

Draft Day Cheat Sheet

Quick-reference page for draft day. Top players by our model, plus the biggest disagreements with FanGraphs consensus ADP.

Top 10 Batters

#	Player	Pos	Proj Pts	PAR
1	Juan Soto	RF	553	357
2	Jose Ramirez	3B	495	313
3	Shohei Ohtani	DH	471	274
4	Aaron Judge	RF	463	268
5	Bobby Witt	SS	468	255
6	Junior Caminero	3B	415	234
7	Vladimir Guerrero	1B	410	233
8	Ketel Marte	2B	390	211
9	Ben Rice	1B	381	204
10	Fernando Tatis	RF	395	199

Top 10 Pitchers

#	Player	Proj Pts	PAR
1	Tarik Skubal	519	303
2	Garrett Crochet	474	257
3	Chris Sale	463	247
4	Zack Wheeler	436	219
5	Brandon Woodruff	420	203
6	Bryan Woo	418	202
7	Logan Gilbert	414	198
8	Josh Hader	350	198
9	Mason Miller	350	198
10	Hunter Greene	411	195

Top 5 Value Picks (All Positions)

Player	Pos	Our #	ADP #	Diff
Pablo Lopez	P	67	740	+673
Spencer Schwellenbach	P	76	740	+664
Corbin Burnes	P	125	732	+607
Brandon Pfaadt	P	104	654	+550
Mitch Keller	P	64	550	+486

Top 5 Fades (All Positions)

Player	Pos	Our #	ADP #	Diff
Roman Anthony	RF	197	52	-145
Wyatt Langford	LF	178	41	-137
Zach Neto	SS	163	30	-133
Austin Riley	3B	167	62	-105
Freddy Peralta	P	144	57	-87

Remember: VALUE picks are players the market is sleeping on - draft them earlier than ADP. FADES are players the market may be overhyping - let someone else overdraft them. Always cross-reference with injury news and spring training reports before draft day.

Appendix: Model Architecture Summary

Component	Detail
Algorithm	XGBoost + LightGBM ensemble (Ridge-blended)
Training Data	2017-2023 seasons (7 years)
Validation	2023 (last CV fold + blend fitting)
Test Set	2024 features -> 2025 actuals
Prediction Target	2025 features -> 2026 projected points
Batter Features	33 (Statcast, rate stats, deltas, RE24)
Pitcher SP Features	33 (arsenal, Statcast, rate stats)
Pitcher RP Features	35 (includes is_closer, p_gf)
Optuna Trials	100 per seed x 5 seeds x 2 model types
CV Strategy	3-fold expanding-window TSCV
Loss Function	Pseudo-Huber (robust to outliers)
COVID Handling	2020 rows downweighted 50%
Pitcher IP Threshold	50 IP (150 outs)
Batter PA Threshold	200 PA

Seed Stability Results

Model	XGB Spearman Range	LGB Spearman Range	Selected By
Batter	0.185 (0.703-0.888)	0.122 (0.862-0.984)	Median Spearman
Pitcher SP	0.265 (0.727-0.992)	0.159 (0.825-0.984)	Median Spearman
Pitcher RP	0.036 (0.964-1.000)	0.068 (0.932-1.000)	Median Spearman

The Spearman range across seeds tells us how much randomness affects results. The SP model's 0.265 XGB range is concerning - it means a 'lucky' seed can make the model look great (0.992) while an 'unlucky' seed makes it look mediocre (0.727). The median selection strategy ensures we get a representative result, not an extreme one.